Unwrapping the Gift: Benefits of Computer Technology

Lecture 2

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Benefits to medicine



- Sophisticated medical imaging
- Reduced surgery time
- Training surgeons
- Faster recovery time (e.g. minimally invasive surgery)
- Patient monitoring
- Improved treatments
- Patient records
  - More legible
  - Better organized
  - Accessible by many sites, simultaneously
  - Available immediately

Benefits to medicine

- Diagnosis
  - Streamlined diagnosis
  - Improved accuracy
  - Reduced need for biopsy
  - Improved screening and predictions
- Telemedicine
  - Broad access to medical help
  - Less expensive
  - Expands consultations beyond rural/remote sites



Benefits to disabled



- Disability-specific computer applications (e.g., a braille printer, large size print).
- Control of household and workplace appliances via speech (people who can't use their hands.)
- Mobility
- Control of artificial limbs
- Improved vision (e.g. large font sizes)
- Access to adaptive educational equipment
- Improved communication (e.g. speech input for people who can't write, speech synthesis for those who can't talk)
- Opportunity to return to work

Benefits - Automation



- Organize and access large inventories
- Cost-saving
- Time-saving
- Improved customer satisfaction
- Tedious, monotonous work done by machines
- Improved workplace safety

Identifying people and products



- E.g. Bar codes & smart cards –
- Time-saving
- Accuracy
- Ease-of-use
- Cost-saving
- More secure
- Customizable
- Reliable

Monitoring Environment and Materials



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Benefits of Computers in Reducing Paper Use and Garbage



- Send/receive digital documents instead of hardcopy.
- Read, write, and edit online.
- Cost-saving; smaller storage needed.
- Creation of toxic wastes at paper mills reduced.

Other Benefits

- ❑ Tracking
- ❑ Rare plants and animals
- ❑ Migration habits
- ❑ Stolen goods
- ❑ Lost pets or people

Thank You